

Jesus Glass

Milo's living room badly needed a centerpiece, or at least something vibrant to block the view of his neighbor practicing the bagpipes in a bathrobe. So, when he found a massive, heavy pane of colored glass at a local church rummage sale for five bucks, it felt like a total steal. It didn't have any drawings, figures, or symbols on it, as it was simply an abstract mosaic of vibrant, multi-colored glass chunks separated by thick, dark lead lines running every which way. But because the seller confirmed it had been salvaged from a demolished 19th-century chapel, the piece radiated an undeniable, heavy church energy.

Trouble started brewing the very next morning when the sun rose. Red and blue light flooded the apartment, painting a giant, glowing halo directly over Arthur's sink full of three-day-old dishes. Suddenly, the air in the room felt distinctly heavier, smelling faintly of ancient frankincense instead of his usual cheap air freshener. Arthur sat down to eat a bowl of sugary kids' cereal, but under that vibrant, multi-colored gaze, he felt an overwhelming wave of existential shame. Even his sofa seemed to stiffen up, its cushions suddenly refusing to let him slouch into his customary potato-like shape.

Determined to ignore the guilt, Arthur invited his friend Leo over for Friday night beers and video games. The vibe, however, was completely ruined. Every time Leo cursed at the TV screen, a cloud passed over the sun, casting the room into an ominous, shadowy gloom. When Arthur tried to crack open a bag of chips, the crinkling sound echoed so loudly it felt borderline sacrilegious.

"Dude," Leo whispered, nervously eyeing the window illumination. "I feel like your wall decor wants to speak to the manager of my soul."

Leo left thirty minutes later, claiming he suddenly felt an urgent, burning need to call his mother and apologize for his teenage years.

The true breaking point arrived on church Sunday. Arthur just committed a terrible roommate crime when he ate his buddy's expensive, artisanal leftover lasagna and blamed it on a fictional building ghost. As he wiped the stolen marinara sauce from his chin, the clouds outside parted with aggressive timing. A beam of blinding, multi-colored light shot through the stained glass window, projecting a giant, ruby-red hand of judgment right onto Arthur's chest.

The sheer weight of silent disapproval in the room was crushing. Panic seized him. Dropping to his knees on the hardwood floor, Arthur buried his face in his hands.

"Forgive me father, for I have sinned," he whimpered, his voice trembling as if he were facing a celestial tribunal. "I ate the lasagna, I haven't flossed since the Obama administration, and I've been using the neighbor's un-passworded Wi-Fi for two years!"

Instantly, a passing pigeon landed on the outside windowsill, perfectly blocking the glowing face of the robed figure. The oppressive aura vanished. Arthur gasped, feeling an immediate wave of absolution, though he knew his freedom was entirely temporary. He stood up, dusted off his sweatpants, and immediately went to wash every dish in the sink. The apartment didn't just have a piece of thrifted art anymore, it had a full-time spiritual landlord.